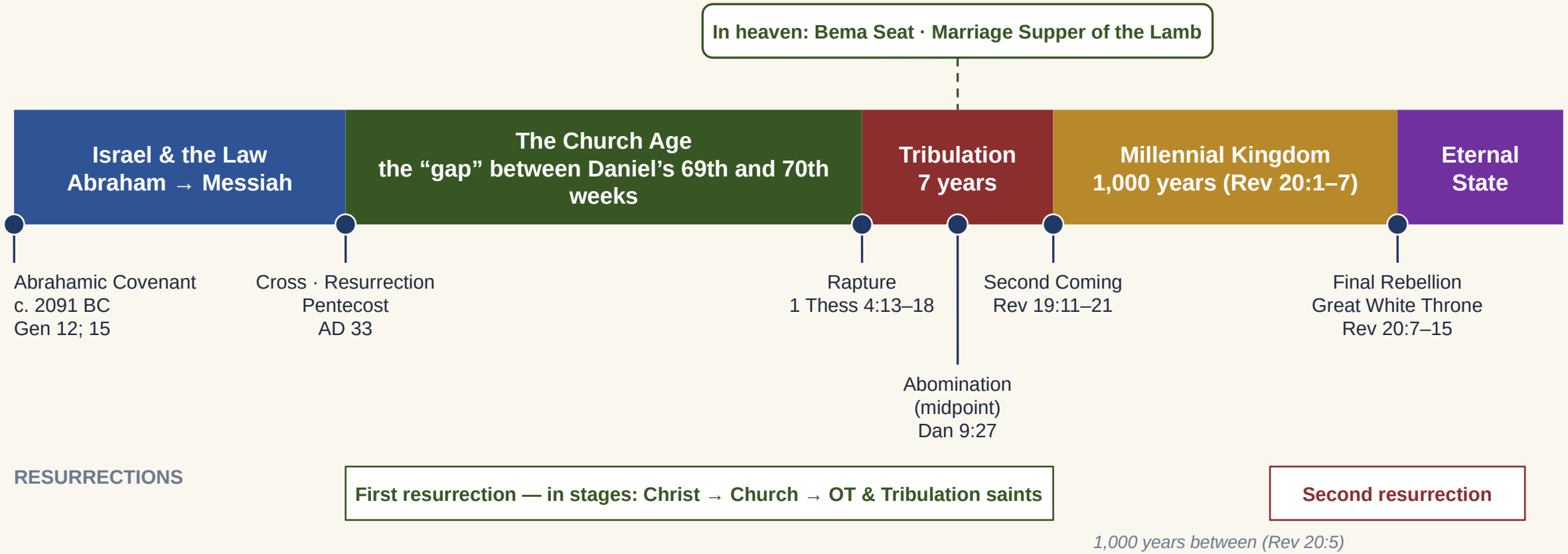
The Prophetic Program at a Glance

From the Abrahamic Covenant to the Eternal State · not to scale



The Seven Dispensations

Each economy: a revelation of God's will, a test, human failure, and judgment (Ryrie)

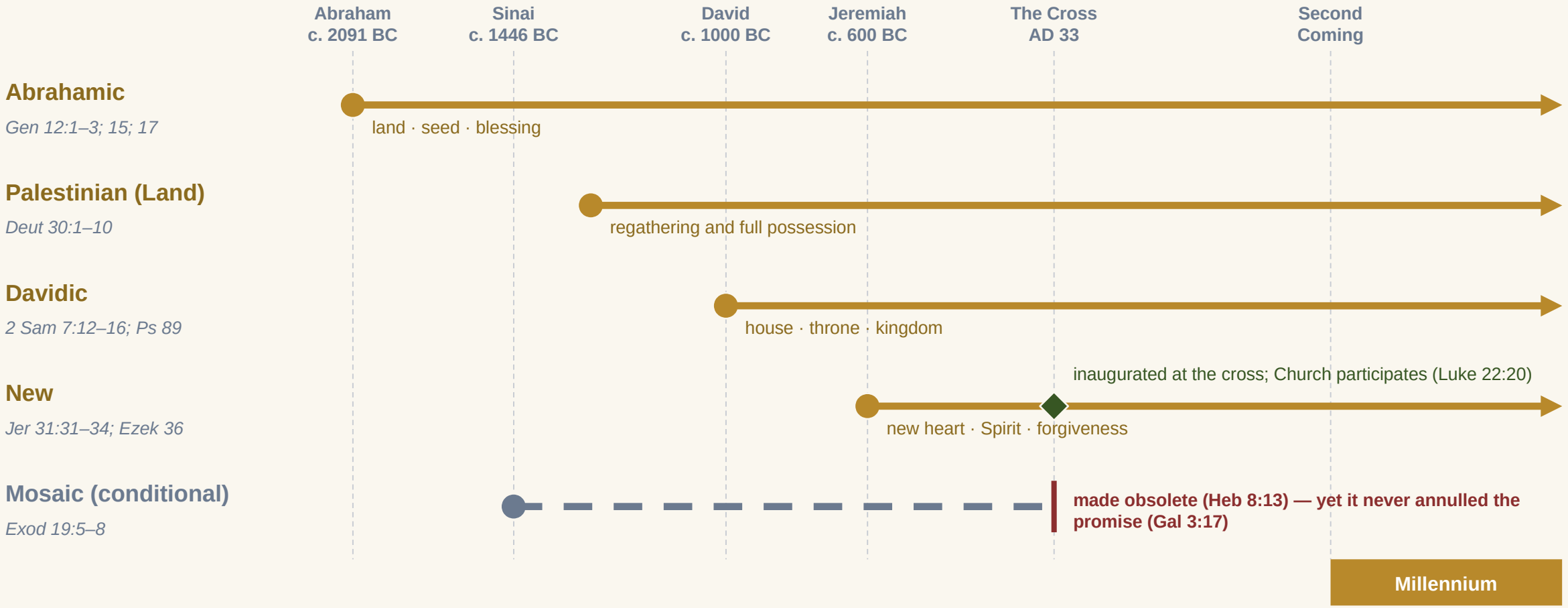
	Innocence	Conscience	Human Gov't	Promise	Law	Grace	Kingdom
SCRIPTURE	Gen 1:28–3:6	Gen 3:7–8:14	Gen 8:15–11:9	Gen 11:10–Exod 18	Exod 19–Acts 1	Acts 2–Rapture	Rev 20:1–6
THE TEST	Obey God in Eden	Do good by conscience	Govern; fill the earth	Trust God's promises	Obey the Mosaic Law	Believe in Christ	Obey the King
FAILURE	Ate the forbidden fruit	Universal wickedness (Gen 6:5)	Babel — refused to scatter	Went down to Egypt	Broke the Law; rejected Messiah	Widespread rejection, apostasy	Final rebellion (Rev 20:7–9)
JUDGMENT	**The Fall; expulsion from Eden**	**The Flood**	**Languages confused**	**Bondage in Egypt**	**Exile; times of the Gentiles**	**Rapture, then the Tribulation**	**Fire from heaven; Great White Throne**

One eternal plan, administered in successive stewardships (oikonomia — Eph 3:2; Col 1:25)

Each dispensation ends in human failure and divine judgment, yet advances God's redemptive purpose toward the consummation (Section I.B).

Four Unconditional Covenants and One Conditional

The covenant foundation of Old Testament eschatology · approximate dates · not to scale



Israel's failure under the Mosaic Covenant cannot cancel the four covenants God confirmed by His own oath (Section I.D).

Where Do the Seventy Weeks Begin?

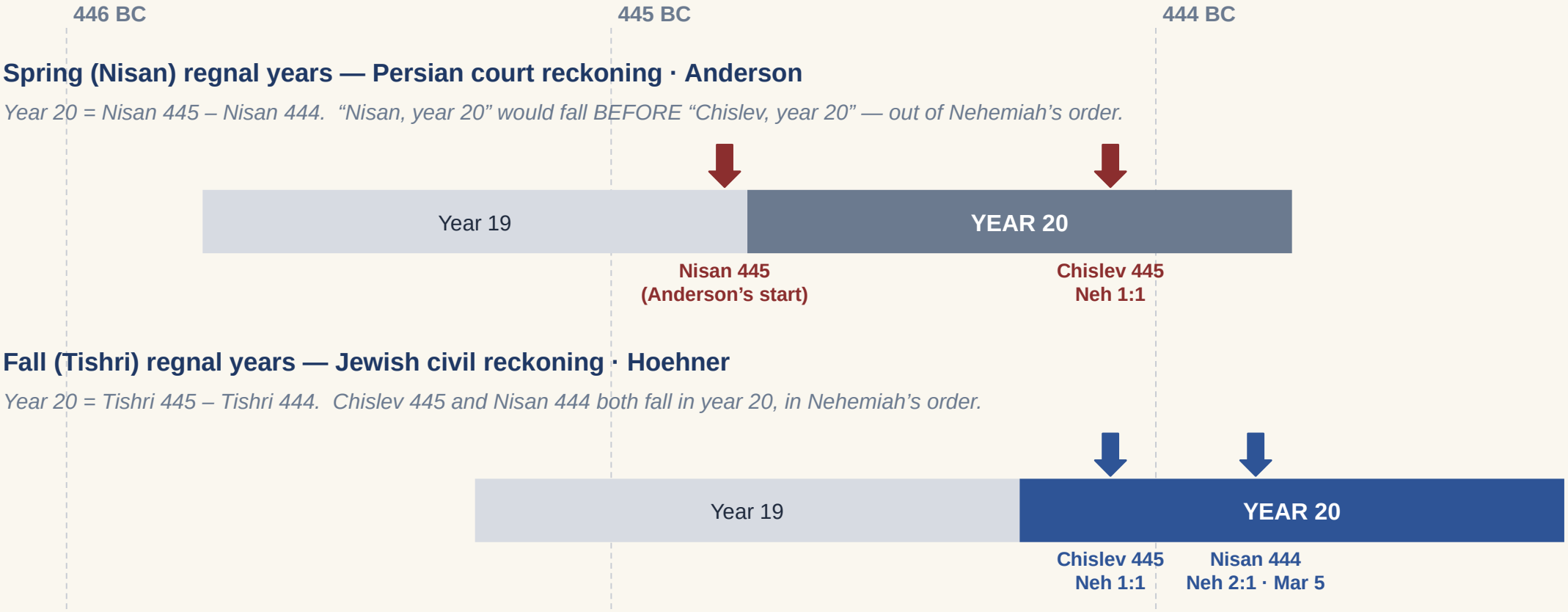
Four Persian decrees tested against Daniel 9:25 — “to restore and rebuild Jerusalem”

Cyrus II · 538 BC **Ezra 1:1–4**	Temple only — “build Him a house”	+483 solar years = 56 BC no Messianic event
Darius I · 520 BC **Ezra 6:6–12**	Reconfirms the temple decree	No viable terminus
Artaxerxes to Ezra · 457 BC **Ezra 7:11–26**	Temple worship, sacrifices, the Law	Minority view: AD 27 (baptism) solar years, not prophetic
Artaxerxes to Nehemiah · 444 BC **Neh 2:1–8**	**The CITY — walls, gates, timber**	**173,880 days → Nisan 10, AD 33** **Triumphal Entry**

Only Nehemiah’s commission addresses the city itself. Nehemiah 1:3 still reports the walls broken down after the earlier decrees.

The 20th Year of Artaxerxes: 445 or 444 BC?

Nehemiah dates two events to the same "twentieth year": Chislev (1:1), then Nisan (2:1)



Result: Nehemiah's commission = Nisan 444 BC → 173,880 days → Nisan 10, AD 33 (Hoehner)

Nisan 10 to Nisan 14, AD 33

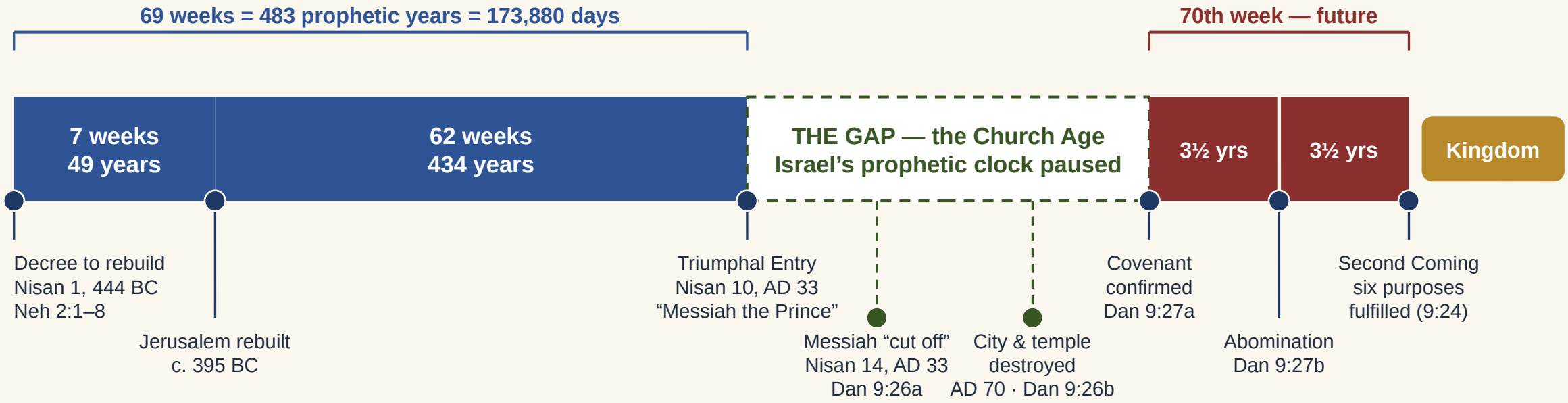
The lamb selected, the King presented, the Lamb slain · Julian dates per Hoehner (Section II.F–G)

	Nisan 10 Mon · Mar 30	Nisan 11 Tue · Mar 31	Nisan 12 Wed · Apr 1	Nisan 13 Thu · Apr 2	Nisan 14 Fri · Apr 3
THE PASSOVER LAMB	**Lamb selected** **Exod 12:3**	Lamb kept and examined Exod 12:6			**Lamb slain** **Exod 12:6**
THE MESSIAH	**Triumphal Entry** **“Messiah the Prince”** **69 weeks complete** **Luke 19:41–44**	Teaching daily in the temple (Luke 19:47)			**Crucified — Messiah** **“cut off” (Dan 9:26)** **“Christ our Passover”** **1 Cor 5:7**
THE HEAVENS					**Darkness noon–3 PM** **Partial lunar eclipse** **at sundown***

** An independently confirmed astronomical event, not referenced in Scripture and not a fulfillment of Joel 2:31, which belongs to the Day of the LORD (Section II.G).*

Daniel’s Seventy Weeks

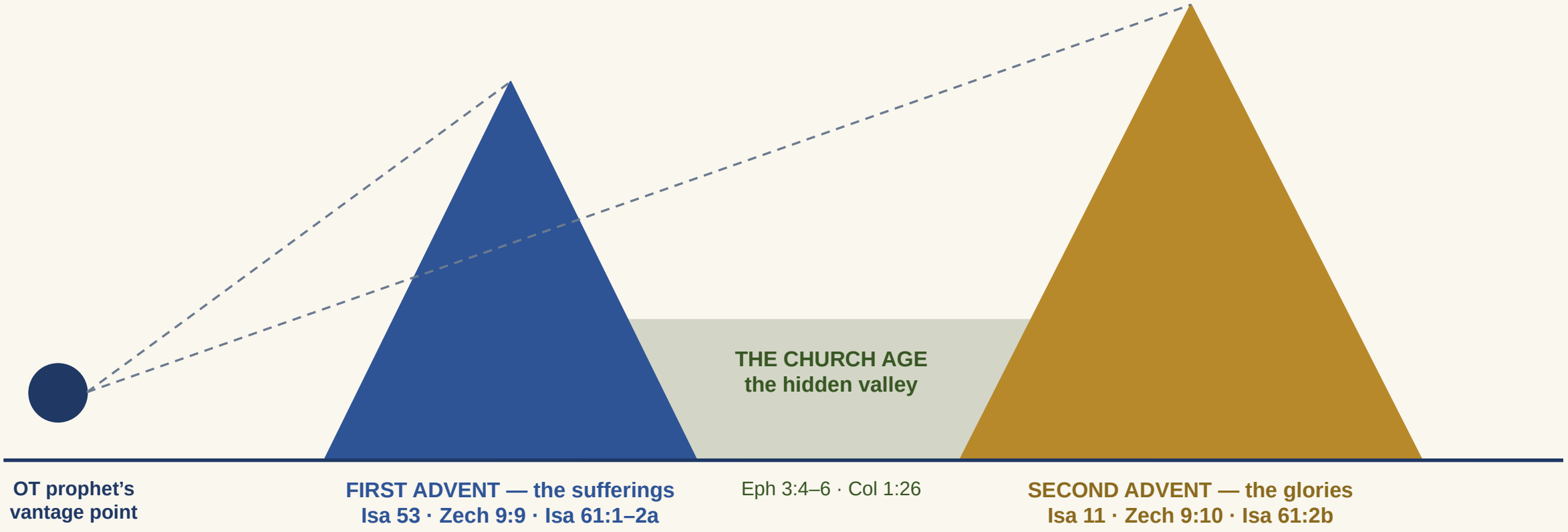
Daniel 9:24–27 · 70 × 7 = 490 prophetic years · dates follow Hoehner (Section II.F) · not to scale



Events of Dan 9:26 fall after the 69th week and before the 70th — the grammar that establishes the gap.

The Two-Mountain View of Prophecy

1 Peter 1:10–12 · the prophets saw “the sufferings of Christ and the glories to follow”



From the prophet’s side the two peaks look like one event. The valley between them — the Church Age — was a mystery not revealed until the New Testament.

Two Thousand Years in a Comma

Isaiah 61:1–2 as Jesus read it in Nazareth · Luke 4:16–21

Jesus stopped reading here

“…to proclaim the favorable year of the LORD,”

Isaiah 61:2a

,

“and the day of vengeance of our God”

Isaiah 61:2b

THE CHURCH AGE
~2,000 years and counting

FIRST ADVENT — fulfilled

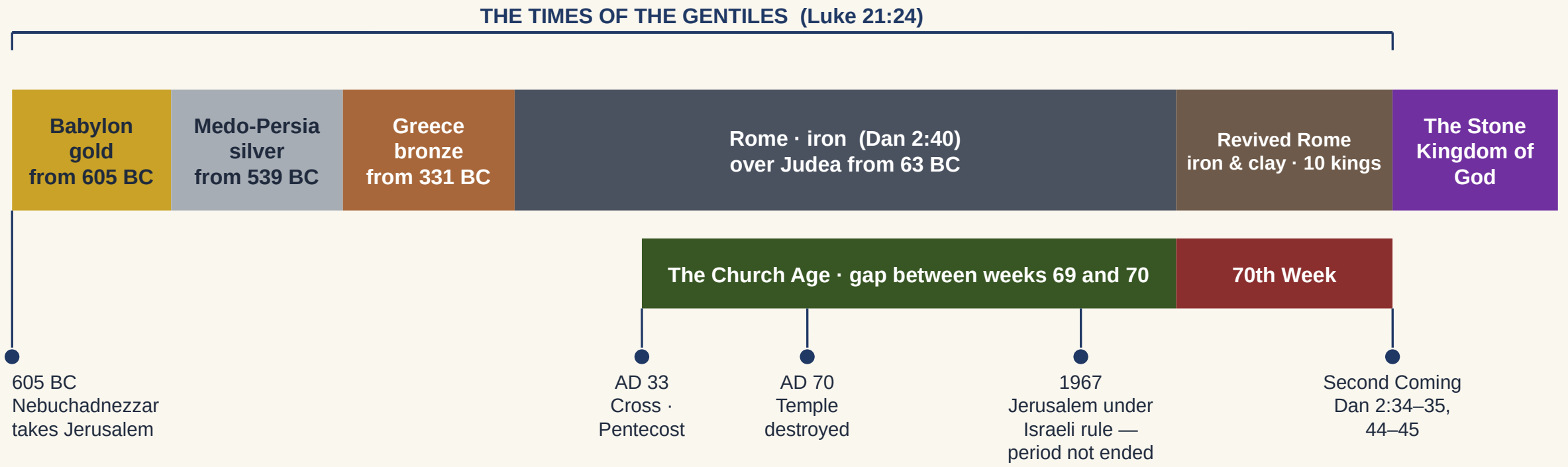
Jesus closed the scroll here and said, “Today this Scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing” (Luke 4:20–21).

SECOND ADVENT — still future

The words Jesus left unread describe the judgment He brings at His return (Rev 19:11–15).

The Times of the Gentiles

Luke 21:24 · Daniel 2 and 7 · Gentile dominance over Jerusalem, Babylon to the Second Coming · not to scale



The period is marked by Gentile control of Jerusalem, not by Gentile world power alone (Fruchtenbaum, Footsteps of the Messiah, p. 21). The modern State of Israel exists within it, not after it.

Daniel 2 and Daniel 7: One History, Two Visions

Nebuchadnezzar's statue and Daniel's four beasts describe the same sequence of kingdoms

KINGDOM	DANIEL 2 — the statue	DANIEL 7 — the beasts
Babylon	Head of gold (2:32, 38)	Lion with eagle's wings (7:4)
Medo-Persia	Chest and arms of silver (2:32, 39)	Bear raised up on one side (7:5)
Greece	Belly and thighs of bronze (2:32, 39)	Leopard with four wings, four heads (7:6)
Rome	Legs of iron (2:33, 40)	Terrifying beast with iron teeth (7:7, 19)
Revived Rome	Feet and toes of iron and clay (2:33, 41–43)	Ten horns and the little horn (7:7–8, 24)
God's Kingdom	Stone cut without hands fills the earth (2:34–35, 44–45)	Son of Man receives the kingdom (7:13–14, 27)

Daniel 2 shows the kingdoms as men see them — precious metals; Daniel 7 shows them as God sees them — beasts. Both end with God's kingdom replacing them all.

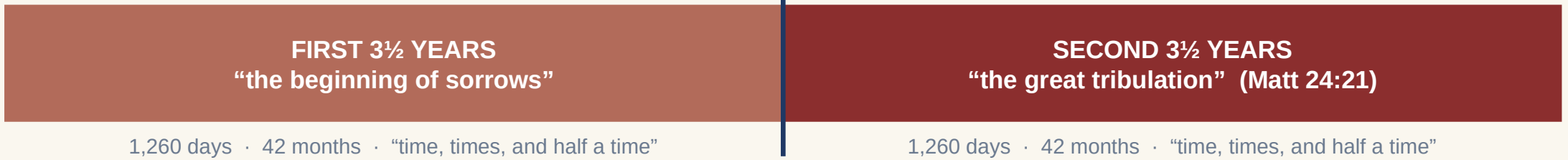
Daniel’s 70th Week — The Tribulation

Daniel 9:27 · 7 years = 2,520 days on the 360-day prophetic year

Covenant confirmed with Israel
Dan 9:27a

MIDPOINT: covenant broken · Abomination of Desolation
Dan 9:27b · Matt 24:15 · 2 Thess 2:4

Second Coming
Rev 19:11–21



1,260 days · 42 months · “time, times, and half a time”

1,260 days · 42 months · “time, times, and half a time”

First half

- Antichrist’s rise and a false peace (Rev 6:2)
- Seal judgments 1–7 (Rev 6; 8:1)
- 144,000 sealed; a great multitude saved (Rev 7)
- Two Witnesses prophesy 1,260 days (Rev 11:3)

Second half

- Image worshiped; mark of the beast (Rev 13:14–18)
- Remnant flees to the wilderness (Rev 12:6, 14)
- Trumpet judgments (Rev 8–9) and bowl judgments (Rev 16)
- Babylon falls; Armageddon campaign (Rev 16–18)

The Rapture of the Church precedes the 70th week (Section IV).

Who Are the Two Witnesses?

Revelation 11:3–13 · three identifications

What all agree the text says: 1,260 days in Jerusalem · sackcloth · fire, drought, water to blood · killed by the beast · bodies lie 3½ days · raised and taken up in view of their enemies

Moses and Elijah ★

Majority dispensational view — Pentecost, Walvoord, Ryrie

- Mal 4:5–6 promises Elijah before the Day of the LORD
- Moses and Elijah appear together at the Transfiguration (Matt 17:3)
- Their powers match: water to blood; no rain (Rev 11:6)

Enoch and Elijah

Minority view — Tertullian, Hippolytus

- The only two who never died (Gen 5:24; 2 Kgs 2:11)
- “Appointed for men to die once” (Heb 9:27) — their deaths remain
- Enoch was a prophet (Jude 14–15)

Symbolic figures

Amillennial and some historic premillennial interpreters

- The Law and the Prophets, or the Church’s witness
- Not the standard dispensational position
- The text’s concrete detail argues for real individuals

★ *Preferred in this study; the Enoch–Elijah view is acknowledged as legitimate and biblically grounded (Section V.C).*

Seals, Trumpets, and Bowls

The telescoping structure of Revelation's judgments · Revelation 6–16

7 SEALS

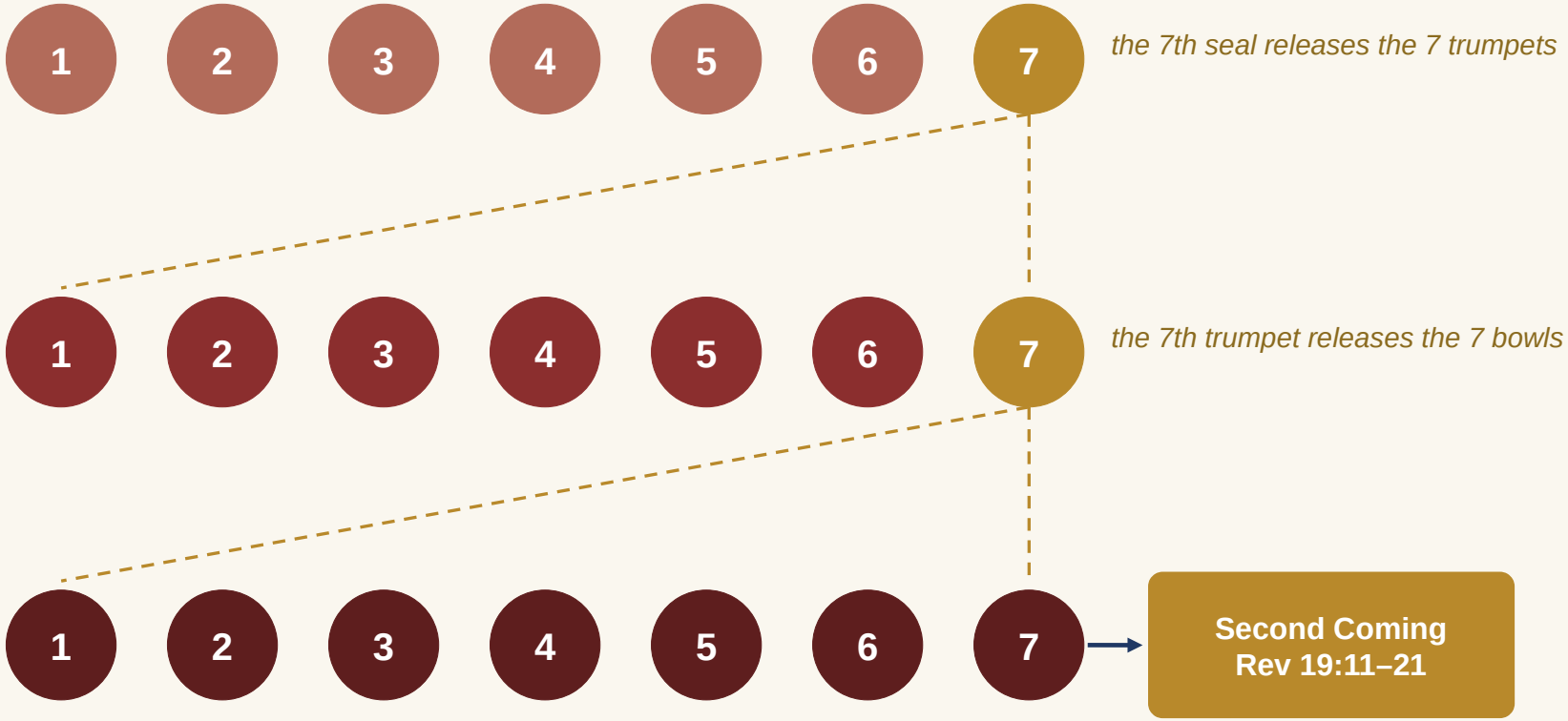
Rev 6:1–8:1
opened by the Lamb

7 TRUMPETS

Rev 8:2–9:21; 11:15–19
sounded by angels

7 BOWLS

Rev 16
"the wrath of God is finished"



"A crescendo of divine wrath reaching its climax in the personal return of Jesus Christ" — Walvoord

The Seven Seal Judgments

Revelation 6:1–8:1 · first half of the 70th week · opened by the Lamb

1 White horse

Rev 6:1–2

The Antichrist rides out as a false peacemaker — a crown and a bow but no arrow. The nations accept a counterfeit peace.

2 Red horse

Rev 6:3–4

Peace is taken from the earth and men slay one another. The false peace gives way to war on an unprecedented scale.

3 Black horse

Rev 6:5–6

Famine and runaway prices: a day's wage buys a quart of wheat. Oil and wine — luxuries — are left untouched.

4 Pale horse

Rev 6:7–8

Death and Hades are given authority over a fourth of the earth: sword, famine, pestilence and wild beasts.

5 Martyrs under the altar

Rev 6:9–11

Souls slain for the word of God cry out for justice. They receive white robes and are told to wait a little longer.

6 Cosmic upheaval

Rev 6:12–17

A great earthquake; the sun black, the moon like blood, stars falling. All ranks of people hide from "the wrath of the Lamb."

7 Silence in heaven

Rev 8:1

Half an hour of silence — a pause of awe before the next series. The seventh seal contains the seven trumpets.

- Opened by Christ Himself (Rev 5:5–6; 6:1)
- Judgments 1–4: the four horsemen
- Seal 4 alone takes a fourth of the earth's people
- The 7th seal releases the trumpets

The seals are not merely permitted but actively initiated by the Lamb — the direct expression of the wrath of God (Rev 6:16–17; Section V.B).

The Seven Trumpet Judgments

Revelation 8:2–9:21; 11:15–19 · sounded by seven angels · trumpets 5–7 are the three woes

1 Hail and fire mixed with blood

Rev 8:7

A third of the earth and a third of the trees burned up, and all green grass. Agricultural catastrophe.

2 A burning mountain into the sea

Rev 8:8–9

A third of the sea becomes blood; a third of sea creatures die; a third of the ships are destroyed.

3 The star Wormwood

Rev 8:10–11

A third of the rivers and springs turn bitter. Many people die from the waters.

4 Sun, moon and stars struck

Rev 8:12–13

A third of the light is darkened. An eagle announces three woes for the trumpets still to come.

5 WOE 1 — locusts from the abyss

Rev 9:1–12

Demonic locusts torment those without God's seal for five months. Men seek death and cannot find it.

6 WOE 2 — the Euphrates army

Rev 9:13–21

Four bound angels released; an army of 200 million kills a third of mankind. The survivors still do not repent.

7 WOE 3 — the kingdom proclaimed

Rev 11:15–19

"The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of His Christ." The seventh trumpet contains the seven bowls.

- Treated in the second half of the week (Section V.E)
- Trumpets 1–4 strike creation by thirds
- Trumpets 5–7 are the three woes (8:13)
- After Seal 4 and Trumpet 6, over half of the world's people have died

"They did not repent" (Rev 9:20–21) — even obvious divine judgment does not soften the hardened heart.

The Seven Bowl Judgments

Revelation 16 · “the seven last plagues” (15:1) · poured out in rapid succession

1 Sores

Rev 16:2

Loathsome, malignant sores on everyone who bears the mark of the beast and worships his image.

2 The sea becomes blood

Rev 16:3

Blood like that of a dead man. Every living thing in the sea dies — not a third, but all.

3 Rivers and springs become blood

Rev 16:4–7

All fresh water turns to blood. “They poured out the blood of saints and prophets… they deserve it.”

4 Scorching sun

Rev 16:8–9

The sun is given power to scorch men with fire. They blaspheme God and do not repent.

5 Darkness on the beast’s throne

Rev 16:10–11

The Antichrist’s kingdom is plunged into darkness; men gnaw their tongues in pain. Still no repentance.

6 The Euphrates dried up

Rev 16:12–16

The way is prepared for the kings from the east. Demonic spirits gather the nations to Armageddon.

7 “It is done!”

Rev 16:17–21

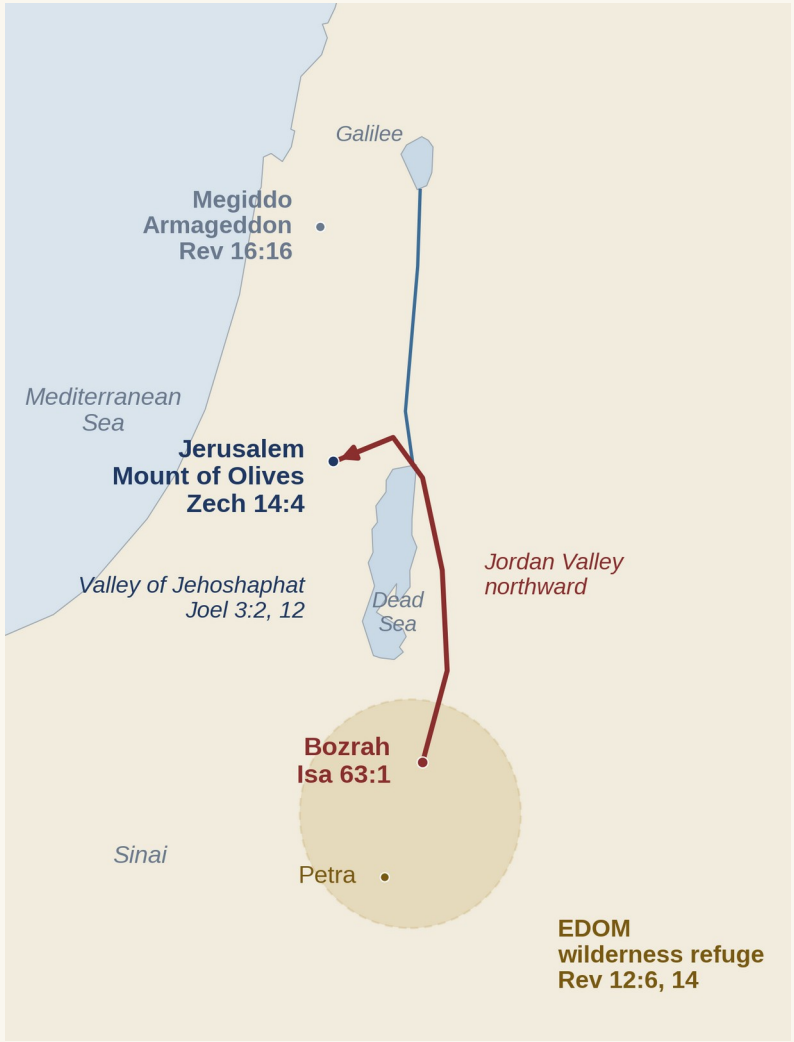
The greatest earthquake in history; Babylon split in three; the cities of the nations fall; hailstones of about 100 pounds.

- “In them the wrath of God is finished” (15:1)
- No intervals — rapid succession at the very end
- Climax: the fall of Babylon (Rev 17–18)
- Followed by the Second Coming (Rev 19:11–21)

Several bowls mirror earlier judgments at full strength — the sea and fresh water now wholly turned to blood (compare Trumpets 2–3).

From Bozrah to the Mount of Olives

The geographic route of the Second Coming · Isaiah 63:1–6 · schematic map



1 **The remnant flees to the wilderness**

"Flee to the mountains" (Matt 24:16); a place prepared by God (Rev 12:6, 14) — the Petra / Bozrah region of Edom

2 **Christ comes to Bozrah**

"Who is this who comes from Edom… from Bozrah?" (Isa 63:1). He gathers His people from their refuge

3 **He advances north through the Jordan Valley**

Treading the winepress alone (Isa 63:3); the source of Rev 19:13, 15

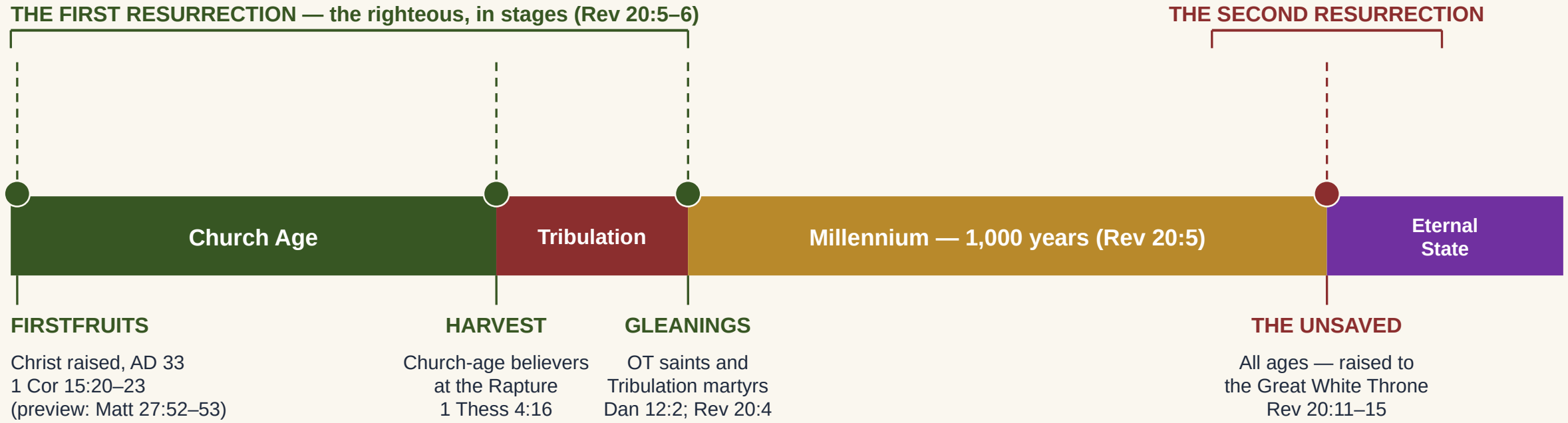
4 **His feet stand on the Mount of Olives**

The mountain splits east to west (Zech 14:4); the nations are judged (Joel 3:2, 12)

Armies gather at Megiddo (Rev 16:16) and converge on Jerusalem (Zech 12:2–3; 14:1–2). Route per Fruchtenbaum, Footsteps of the Messiah, pp. 261–268.

The Program of Resurrections

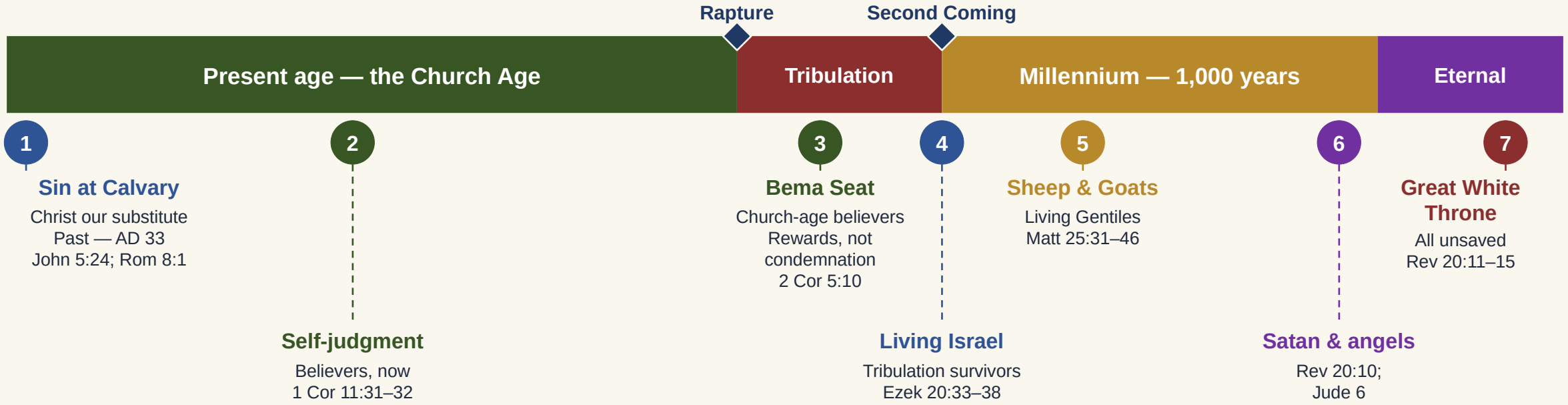
1 Corinthians 15:20–24 · firstfruits, harvest, gleanings — then the resurrection of the unsaved · not to scale



"Blessed and holy is the one who has a part in the first resurrection; over these the second death has no power" (Rev 20:6). The two resurrections stand 1,000 years apart.

The Divine Program of Judgments

Seven judgments, different in time, subjects, basis and result · not to scale



Merging the Bema Seat (3) with the Great White Throne (7) confuses the believer's reward with the unbeliever's condemnation (Section VIII).

Two Kinds of People in the Millennium

Glorified saints and mortal survivors under the reign of Christ · Section IX.E

CHRIST THE KING reigns from Jerusalem · Satan bound in the abyss (Rev 20:1–3)

GLORIFIED SAINTS — resurrected bodies

- Church, OT saints, Tribulation martyrs
- Do not marry or bear children
- Reign with Christ (Rev 20:4; 2 Tim 2:12)
- Cannot die again

MORTAL SURVIVORS — natural bodies

- Believing Israel, purged and restored (Ezek 20:33–38)
- Believing Gentiles — the “sheep” (Matt 25:31–46)
- Marry, bear children, build and plant (Isa 65:21–23)
- Long lives — dying at 100 is dying young (Isa 65:20)

Even with Satan bound and Christ ruling in perfect justice, the unregenerate heart still rebels — sin is in human nature, not only in its surroundings (Section X.B).

Their children, over 1,000 years — born with a sin nature; each must believe personally

Many believe

Others join the final rebellion (Rev 20:7–9)

Isaiah 65 Describes the Millennium

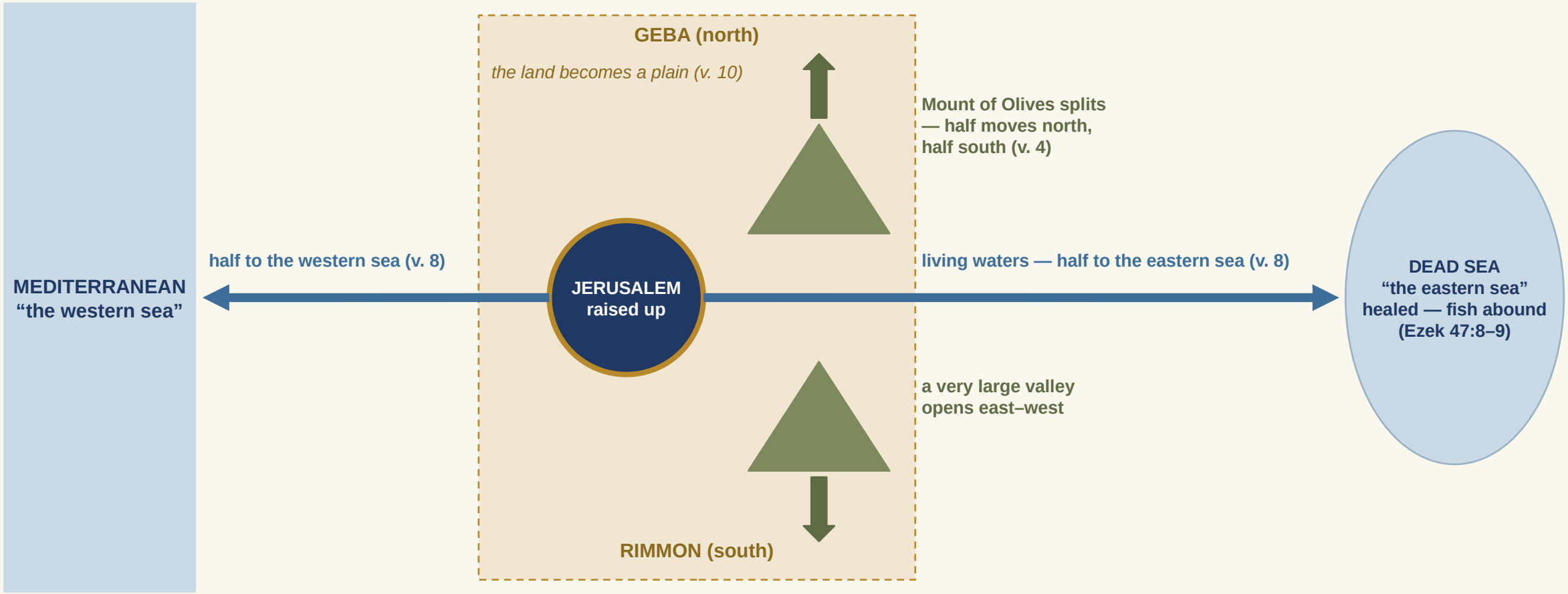
Why Isaiah 65:17–25 cannot be the eternal state of Revelation 21–22

	ISAIAH 65:17–25	REVELATION 21–22
DEATH	Still occurs — “the youth will die at the age of one hundred” (65:20)	“There will no longer be any death” (21:4)
SIN	Still possible — the sinner “will be thought accursed” (65:20)	Nothing unclean will ever enter (21:27)
LIFESPAN	Long but finite — “like the days of a tree” (65:22)	“They will reign forever and ever” (22:5)
DAILY LIFE	Building houses, planting vineyards, bearing children (65:21–23)	God dwells among His people; the first things passed away (21:3–4)

Isaiah 65:17–25 → the MILLENNIUM (a renewed creation) **Revelation 21–22 → the ETERNAL STATE**

Zechariah 14: The Land Transformed

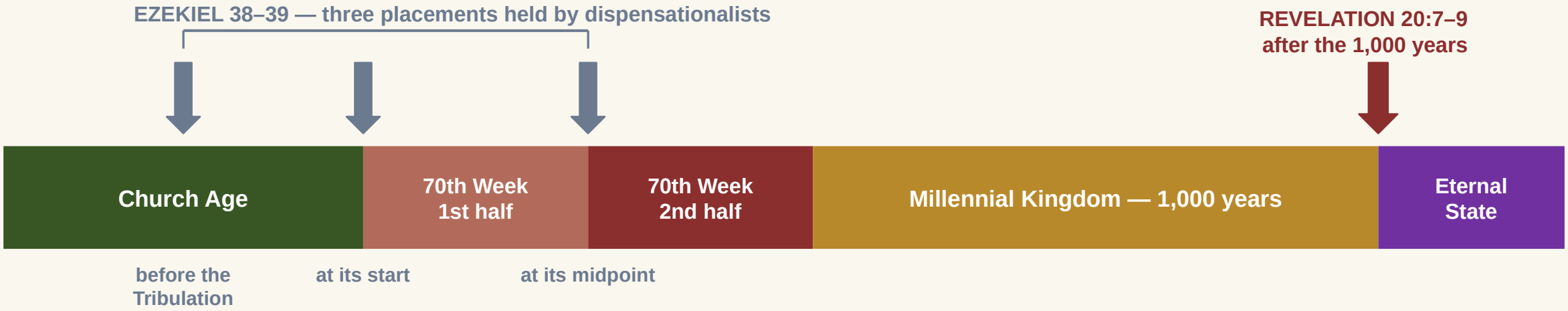
What changes around Jerusalem when Christ's feet stand on the Mount of Olives · schematic, not to scale



"In summer as well as in winter" (v. 8) — a perennial river, parallel to Ezekiel's river from the temple (Ezek 47:1–12).

Gog and Magog: Two Different Battles

Ezekiel 38–39 and Revelation 20:7–9 share a name but not a date



Ezekiel 38–39

- A northern coalition invades Israel
- Destroyed by earthquake, hail, fire and plague
- Before the Millennium

Revelation 20:7–9

- Satan released; nations from the four corners
- Surround Jerusalem; fire from heaven
- After the Millennium — the name used typologically

“Then Comes the End”

1 Corinthians 15:24–28 · from the Millennial Kingdom to the eternal state

1 CHRIST REIGNS

“He must reign until He has put all His enemies under His feet” (v. 25)

The Millennium; the final rebellion crushed (Section X.A)

2 THE LAST ENEMY ABOLISHED

“The last enemy that will be abolished is death” (v. 26)

Death and Hades thrown into the lake of fire (Rev 20:14)

3 THE KINGDOM HANDED OVER

“He hands over the kingdom to the God and Father… that God may be all in all” (vv. 24, 28)

The eternal state; “the throne of God and of the Lamb” (Rev 22:3)

Not the end of Christ’s reign — “His kingdom will have no end” (Luke 1:33) — but the completion of His mediatorial kingdom program (Pentecost; Walvoord).

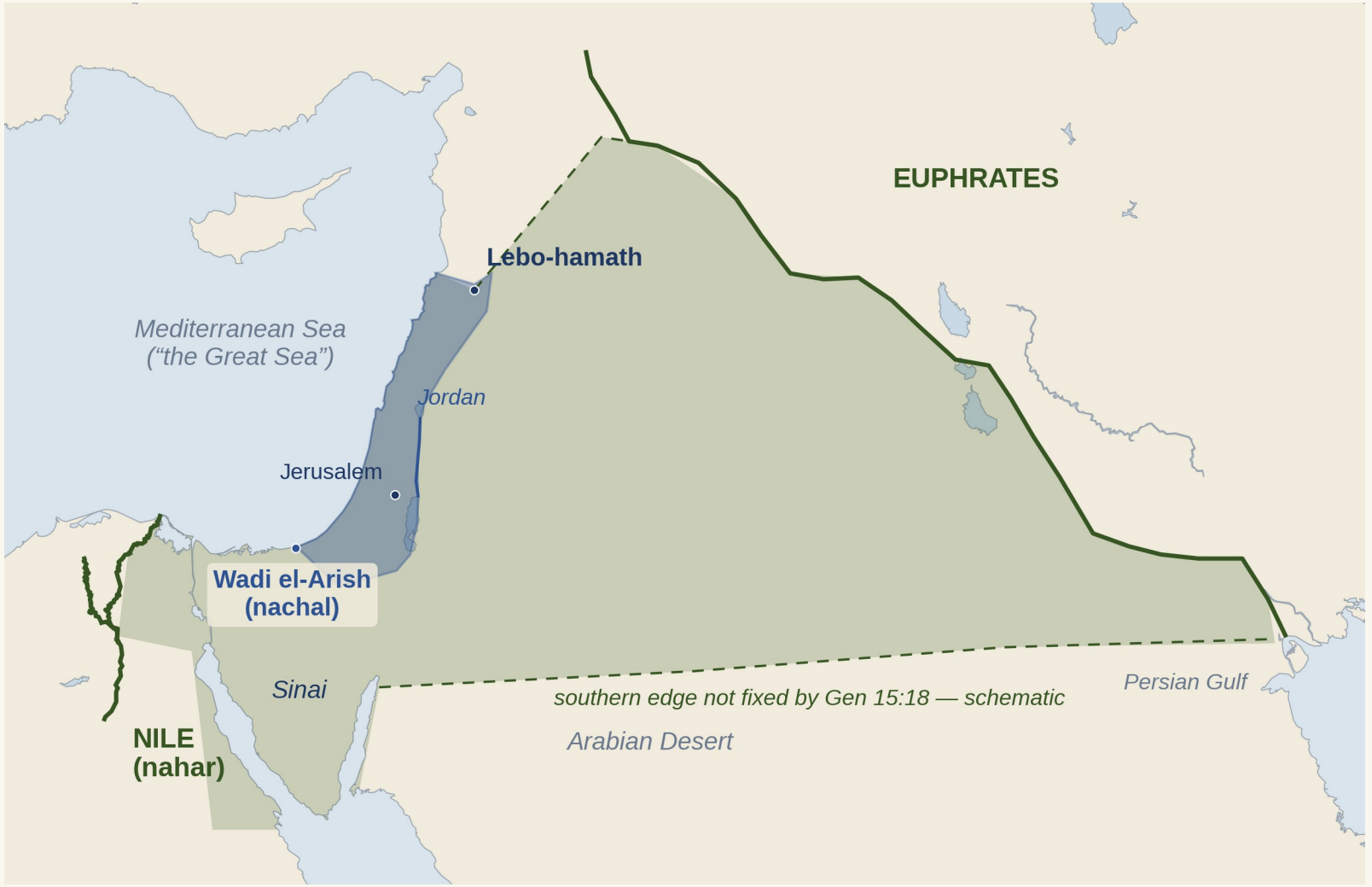
From Eden to the New Jerusalem

What sin corrupted in a garden, God restores — and exceeds — in a city

	GENESIS 1–3 · the garden	*restored*	REVELATION 21–22 · the city
THE RIVER	A river flows out of Eden Gen 2:10	→	The river of the water of life Rev 22:1
THE TREE	The tree of life in the garden Gen 2:9	→	The tree of life, fruit every month Rev 22:2
ACCESS	Cherubim and a flaming sword bar the way Gen 3:22–24	→	Gates never closed; right to the tree Rev 21:25; 22:14
THE CURSE	Ground cursed; toil and pain Gen 3:16–19	→	“There will no longer be any curse” Rev 22:3
DEATH & TEARS	“To dust you shall return” Gen 3:19	→	No death, no tears (cf. Isa 25:8) Rev 21:4
GOD’S PRESENCE	Man driven from God’s presence Gen 3:23–24	→	“The tabernacle of God is among men” Rev 21:3 (cf. Exod 25:8)

The Abrahamic Land Grant: Two Layers

Genesis 15:18 (covenant grant) and Numbers 34 / Ezekiel 47–48 (tribal allotment) · schematic map



Covenant grant

Gen 15:18 — Nile (nahar) to Euphrates. Israel's outer national domain.

Tribal allotment grid

Num 34; Ezek 47:13–20 — Wadi el-Arish (nachal) to Lebo-hamath. Settled by the twelve tribes.

Sovereignty zone

Green beyond the blue: within the grant but not allotted to a tribe — Sinai, Transjordan, Syria and Iraq west of the Euphrates (Isa 19:23–25).

View held: the river of Egypt in Gen 15:18 is the Nile (Pentecost, Walvoord, Ryrie). Alternative view: Wadi el-Arish throughout.

The Millennial Land Allotment

Ezekiel 47:13–48:35 · twelve tribal bands from north to south · schematic, not to scale

NORTH

Dan
Asher
Naphtali
Manasseh
Ephraim
Reuben
Judah

W

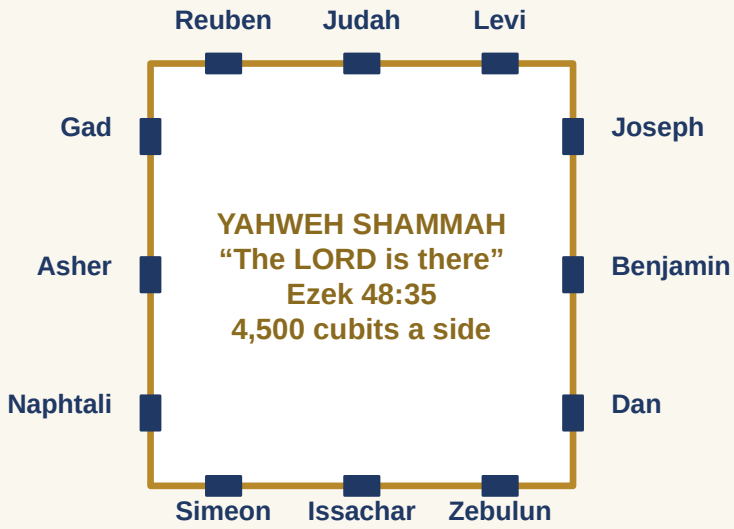
Prince	HOLY ALLOTMENT 25,000 cubits square sanctuary · priests · Levites · city	Prince

E

Benjamin
Simeon
Issachar
Zebulun
Gad

SOUTH

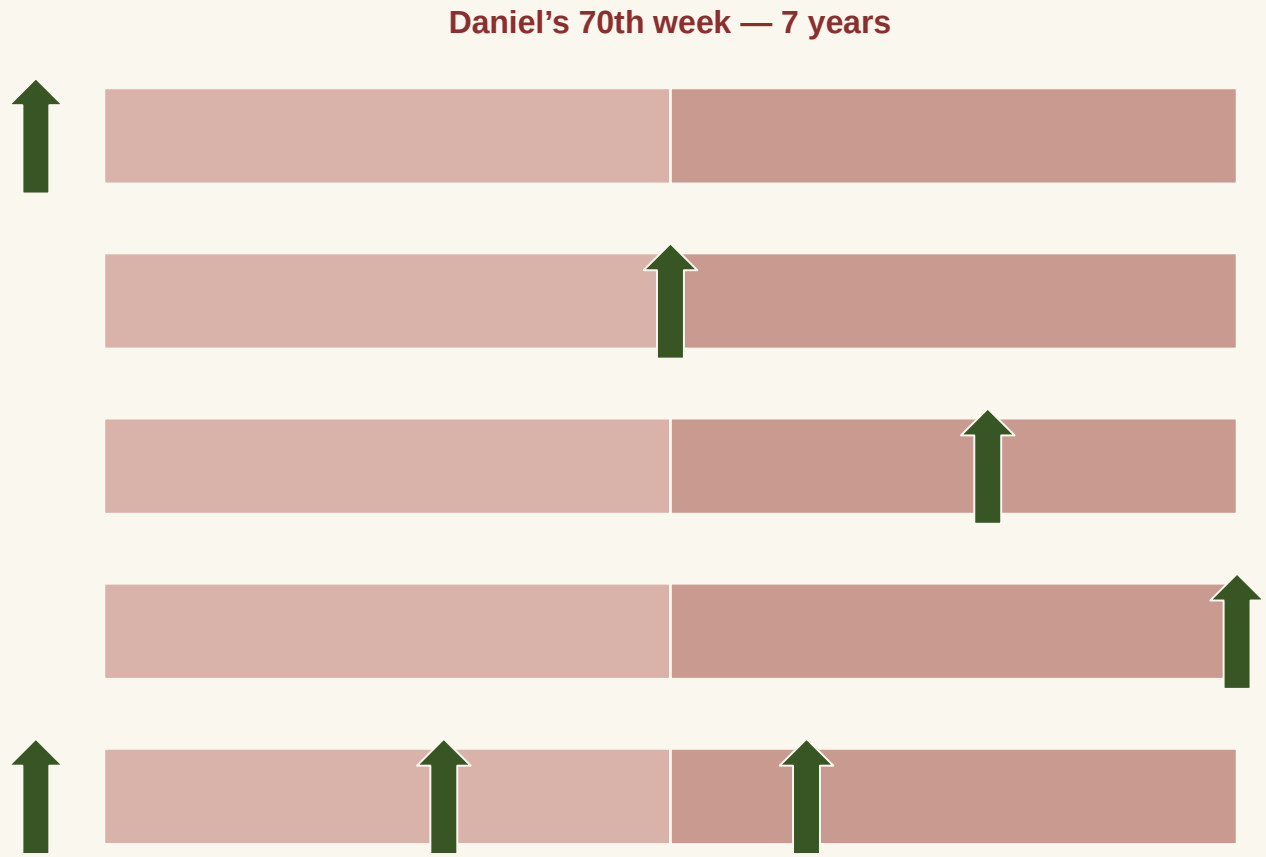
The city and its twelve gates (Ezek 48:30–35)



Joseph receives two portions (Manasseh and Ephraim), so Levi’s name appears on a gate, not a land band (Ezek 47:13; 48:31–32).

When Is the Rapture?

Five views of the Rapture's timing relative to Daniel's 70th week



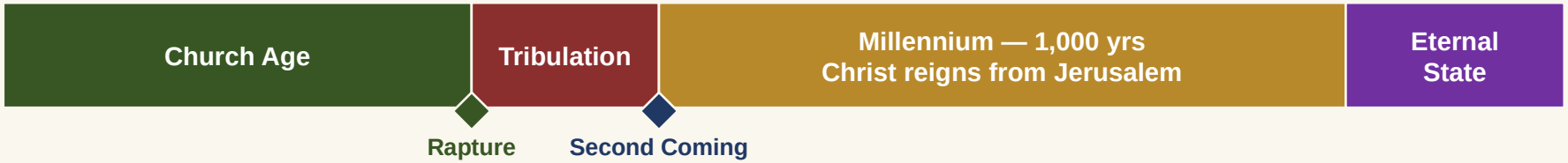
★ *The view held throughout this study. Green arrows mark where each view places the Rapture.*

Four Views of the Millennium

Where each view places the Second Coming and the 1,000 years of Revelation 20 · not to scale

Dispensational premillennial ★

Chafer, Walvoord, Pentecost, Ryrie



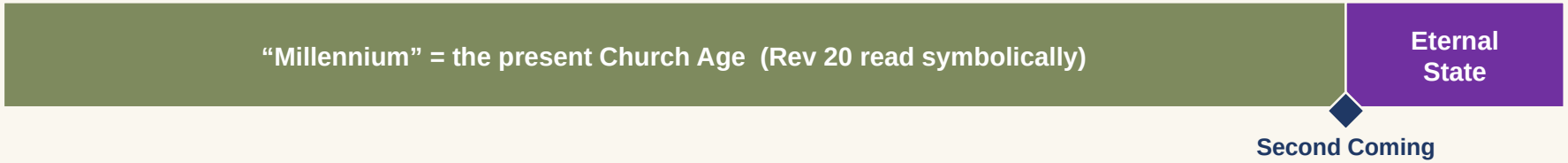
Historic premillennial

Ladd, Blomberg, Schreiner



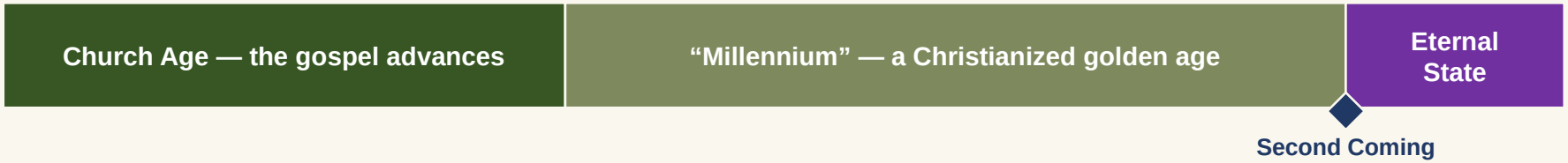
Amillennial

Augustine, Luther, Calvin, Berkhof, Hoekema



Postmillennial

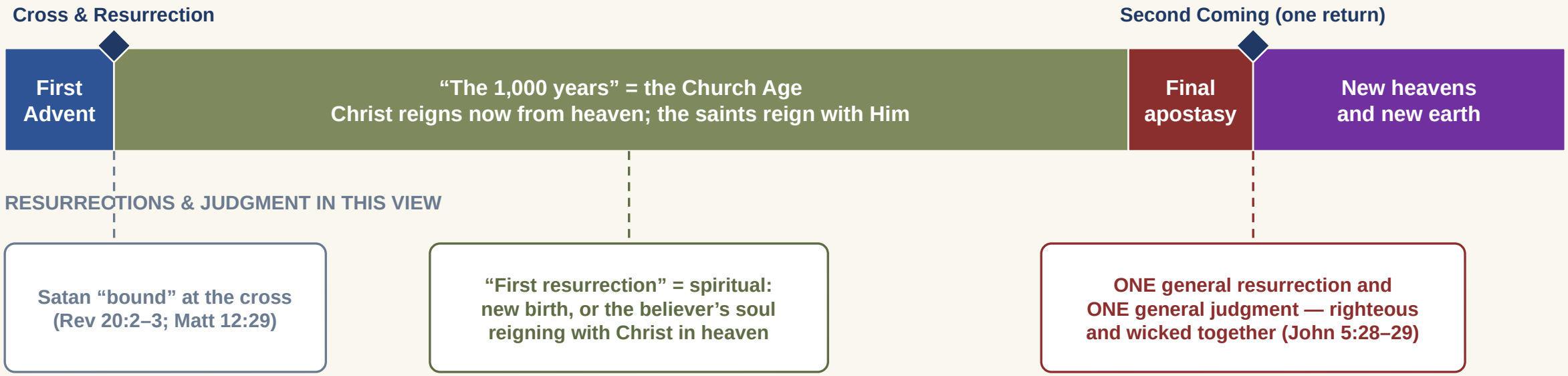
Edwards, Hodge, Warfield; DeMar



★ *The view held throughout this study. Two views place Christ's return before the 1,000 years; two place it after.*

The Amillennial View

No future earthly millennium · the "1,000 years" of Revelation 20 = the present age

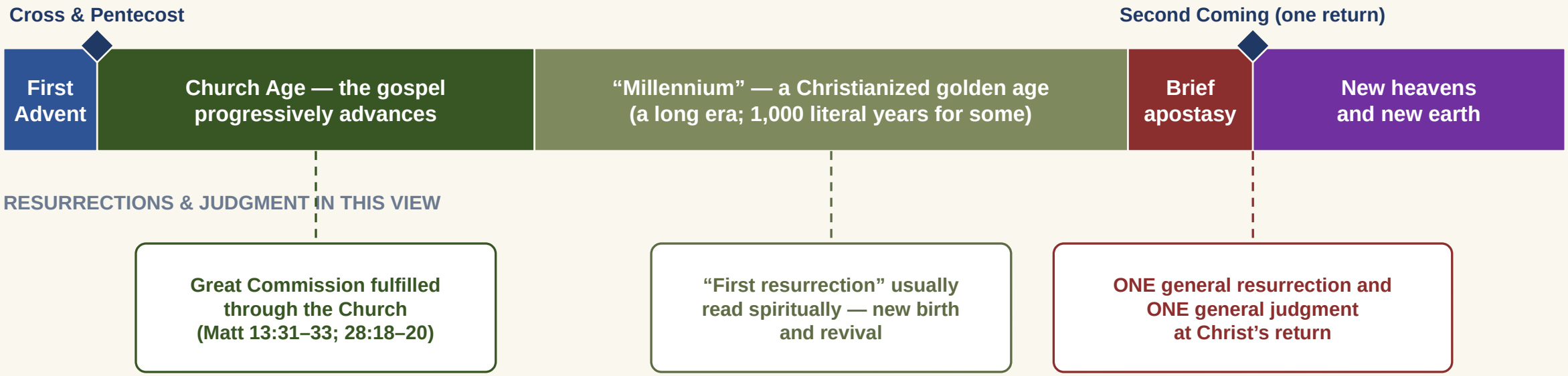


Proponents: Augustine, Luther, Calvin, Berkhof, Hoekema; most Reformed and mainline traditions

This study's view: two bodily resurrections separated by a literal 1,000 years (Rev 20:4–6; Section VII), and distinct judgments at different times (Section VIII). See Appendix F for the assessment.

The Postmillennial View

Christ returns after a golden age brought about through the spread of the gospel

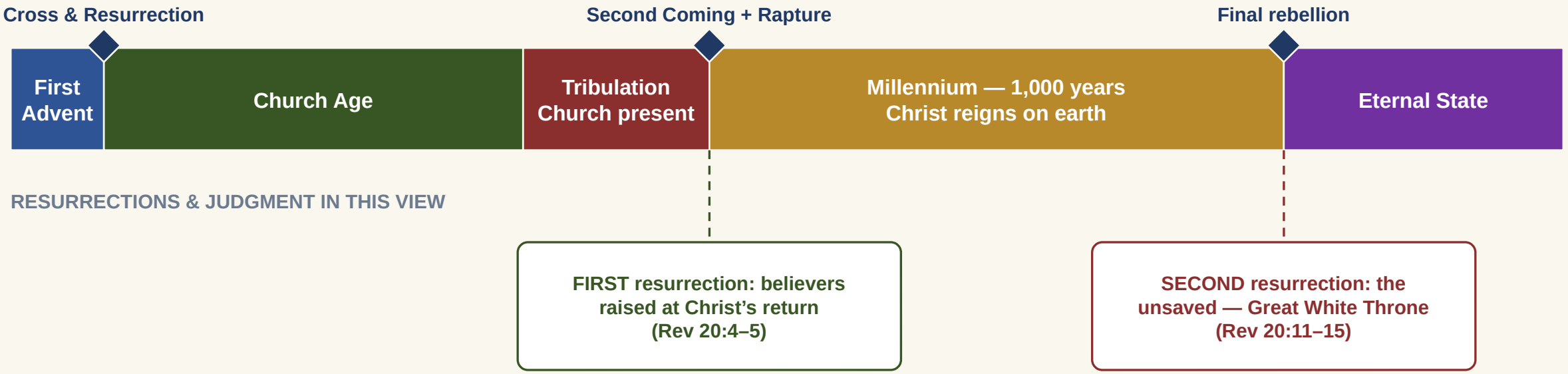


Proponents: Jonathan Edwards, Charles Hodge, B. B. Warfield (historic); Gary DeMar, R. J. Rushdoony (theonomic)

This study’s view: the age ends in apostasy and Tribulation, not a Christianized world (2 Thess 2:3; 2 Tim 3:1–5); Christ returns before the 1,000 years. See Appendix F for the assessment.

The Historic Premillennial View

A literal future millennium — but the Church goes through the Tribulation and inherits Israel's promises



Proponents: George Ladd, Craig Blomberg, Thomas Schreiner; many evangelical Baptists

Shared with this study: a literal future millennium and two resurrections. Different: no pretribulational Rapture, no Bema interval before the return, and no sharp Israel–Church distinction (Sections III, IV).

The Kingdom Promised: By the Numbers

How much of the Old Testament anticipates the Kingdom, and where it is concentrated

1,845+

OT references to the Second Coming and Messianic era (Payne)

≈ 6 : 1

Second-Coming to First-Coming OT references (G.1)

318

NT references to the Second Coming

9

chapters on the Millennial Temple alone (Ezek 40–48)

Kingdom-content density by book (G.3)

